

The Development of C

A majority of the programming languages that exist today were invented in the '70s. In 1972, Dennis Ritchie developed an imperative, procedural, system implementation programming language known as C at The Bell Laboratories to be used with the UNIX operating system. Although C was meant to be used for system software, it is also widely used widely for other applications. C was the beginning of other languages like C++, D, and Objective-C, and also influenced languages like Java, C#, Perl, PHP, JavaScript, and the C Shell.

The language was named C since it had features drawn from an earlier language B, developed in 1969 by Ken Thompson. B was a stripped-down version of the BCPL programming language developed in 1967.

C was the language for the UNIX platform, so the growth and popularity of UNIX led to the growth of C. The kernel of UNIX and most of the other components were eventually rewritten in C.

Dennis Ritchie and Brian Kernighan wrote the first edition of the book *The C programming language*. Several features included in C were mentioned in succeeding editions of the book. Later at The Bell Labs, Dr Bjarne Stroustrup worked on C and developed the enhanced "C with classes" in 1979. It was re-named C++ in 1983.

C++ integrated high-level language qualities as well as low-level languages, and it is used for many kinds of programming, including object-oriented. C++ remains a work in progress; a new version,

Big Talk

Alan Kay, Adele Goldberg, Scott Wallace, Dan Ingalls, Ted Kaehler, and a group of other researchers designed an object-oriented, dynamically-typed programming language called Smalltalk in 1972. Though less well-known, it influenced the evolution of computer technology. The graphical user interface elements created using Smalltalk were incorporated into the Mac OS and Windows.